

FOTOCOPI

NARENDRA KUMAR AHMED The designer's well-cut jackets have found takers like Saif Ali Khan and John Abraham (left), who has gone from slobbish grunge to classic chic.



who is also *Vogue India*'s fashion director—in *Dhoom 2*, in which, among other things, she turned a scrap of orange material she found in Rio de Janeiro into a shirt, and then ripped out its sleeves, for an emblematic song, Roshan has morphed into the king of cool. His jacket-jeans-and-keds combinations have worked well at public appearances and in advertisements.

Similarly for John Abraham, who was in danger of looking slobbish at functions with his regulation jeans-T-shirt-chappals. With Ahmed's well-cut jackets, he's now good to go for most events, and where he needs an extra something, like the white linen shirt and pants for the Kingfisher calendar launch, the designer steps in again. Some stars discover stylists while working with them on a movie. So if Aki Narula has styled Saif's roadie look in the forthcoming *Tashan* (in addition to styling for Akshay Kumar, Anil Kapoor and Katrina Kaif), he also collaborates with the star on photo shoots, where he will slip in a quirky scarf he picked up in Jaisalmer. And Falguni Thakore, who bonded with Abhishek Bachchan

while working on *Rakht's One love*, now also fashions his look for almost all his ads—from the classic suit for the Omega ad to the casual clothes in the LG commercials. Even as she transforms Vivek Oberoi's look, from his hair to physique, in *Mission Istanbul*, she does not fail to pick up accessories that she thinks will look good on Abhishek. She has styled him along with his father and wife in Ram Gopal Varma's forthcoming *Sarkar Raj*.

One look can sometimes have many owners. Take Rohan Sippy's *Bluff Master*. Narula styled Abhishek for the movie, but the *Right here right now* song's pimp daddy look was Adajania's creation, and the black hat worn by co-star

Chopra was picked up by Thakore in Australia. The stylist can go on shopping trips for the star (as Adajania did once for Roshan,

accompanied by a friend with the same measurements), field a call from luxury brands desperate for Bollywood glamour (as Narula did with the Moschino dresses for Dutta as well as Zinta in *Jhoom Barabar Jhoom*), or just turn up with an outfit and not take no for an answer (as

Malhotra did for the usually slovenly Kajol at Abhishek-Aishwarya's sangeet, giving her a white kurta with embellishments and straight pants). Often, the designer doesn't just send a dress across, he sends the shoes, bag and jewellery as well.

Who said it's easy to stand out in a sea of homogenised faces and seamless bodies? ■



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bodies to fit into them. This is not necessarily true of Indian women."

But some women almost always manage to look good. Take Basu, who works mostly with good friend Rocky S, but often experiments with newer kids on the block. But even she doesn't always manage to pull it off—when she picked up a purple bubble dress from Delhi-based designer Drashta Sarvaiya for a *Provogue* show in Delhi and then another beaded mini with a tie-up hemline for the *Goal* premiere in Mumbai, she made heads turn for the wrong reasons.

The right stylist can transform an actor's cool quotient. Take Roshan. After he worked with Adajania—



ANAITA SHROFF ADAJANIA Worked with Hrithik Roshan (right) in *Dhoom 2* and styles his public appearances, such as the one for the MTV Awards.